

Blender: A Superb Tool For 3D Designs And Animations

For computer animation enthusiasts and 3D designers, Blender is a popular and useful software. It is free, open source and highly ergonomic, making creation of 3D designs and models easy. It comes with an extensive number of features to add variety of flavours to your creations. In this article we look into the features that Blender brings to the table.

Getting familiar with Blender

Blender can be an interesting tool to showcase creativity at its maximum. The user interface (UI) at first may look over the top, but breaking it down bit by bit will make the usage easy. After all, it packs a lot of things in one window. It is compatible with many major operating platforms, including Windows (Vista and above), Mac OS X (10.6 and above), Linux as well as FreeBSD.

The interface contains multiple tools and functional areas. The middle of the screen is the main workspace, where the model is visualised and modified. At the top, there is a toolbar that consists of a number of menus and actionable boxes. Menus like File, Add, Render and Help let you access the various operations of the tool. To the left of the workspace, there are a number of quick access keys to object tools like transform operations (rotate, scale translate, etc), object-related operations (duplicate, delete, join, etc), shading operations, adding or removing keyframes, creating motion paths and so on.

The right panel comprises quick settings and property options of the various parameters being used in



Fig 1: Blender user interface (Credit: Blender.org)

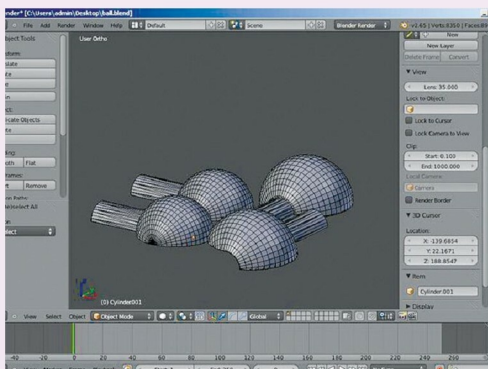


Fig 2: Creating 3D models in Blender (Credit: thingiverse.com)

the design. You can verify variables like resolution, frame range, aspect ratio and anti-aliasing settings, or choose the desired shading and add additional features to the design. You

can also render an image or animation from the right panel directly. All these quick keys play an integral role in designing the perfect model with ease.